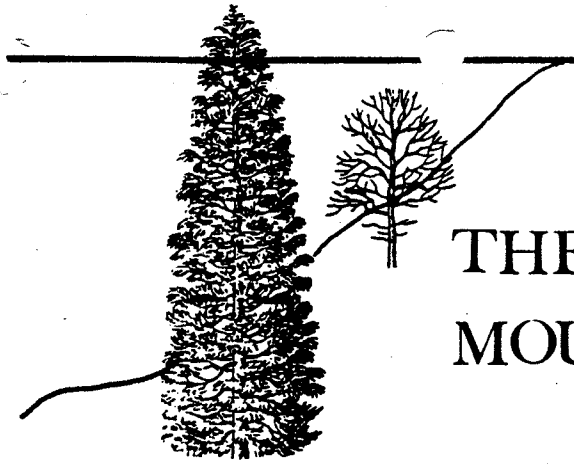


THE MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS

Volume 1, Number 2 March, 1986

"March comes, a kind of interregnum, winter's sovereignty relaxing, spring not yet in control. But the pattern is now established..."

N.Y. Times, March, 1964

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CMA/CDC ISSUES -- PHASE II

The Ad Hoc fact finding committee appointed to advise the Board on CMA/CDC issues presented an interim report at the Board's February 8th meeting. President Don Fox has now expanded the committee to include (in addition to Chairman Dring, Jasper and Kaseman) the following: Charles Barrett, Elmer Broxson, Don Green, Dick Lehman and Richard Minnamon. This group, probably the most "bi-partisan" in our history, has been charged with drawing up a consensus report on CMA's position on the issues, including the quality and safety of water, sewer, and roads. We wish them much luck.

NEW HOMES GOING UP

Bob and Sarah Hay's (F-4) is near completion; finishing touches are being put on James and Joan Bradfield's (N-3); and the William Boydens (P-1) are about to break ground.

CLARIFICATION FROM THE PRESIDENT

The last paragraph of the President's January 22 informational letter to the membership was confusing. For the second sentence, substitute: "When the final report / of the committee at left / has been received, the Board will give it proper consideration in the preparation of the CMA response to Mr. Ashelman's latest proposal. The Board will then send the CMA proposal to Mr. Ashelman for his approval, and if approved, to the membership for your ratification."

RFC "WALKABOUT"

The Recreational Facilities Committee will meet March 22 (Sat.) at "Half Round" (Carl Bostrom's). The agenda includes: lunch at 12:30; an inspection tour of the pool, courts, barn, etc; and a meeting to discuss the pool/'86, maintenance and rental(?) of the tennis courts, pasture and trails, and status of the proposed campsites. Co-chairmen Carl Bostrom and Stephen Crane report that (cont.)

Published by the COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION, Rt. 1, Coolfont Rd., Box 21, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
Editor: Carol M. Green, 3703 Curtis Ct., Chevy Chase MD 20815 Tel. 301/654-7737.

RFC "WALKABOUT" (cont.)

the committee will include Margaret Axtell, Janet Dring, Lorraine Hall, Dick Lehman, Henry Lynn and, hopefully, other participants from among the CMA permanent residents.

ABOUT MEMBERS

--Jacob Andrew Lynn, 9 pounds, 2 ounces, was born January 26 to Board member Henry Lynn and his wife Barbara at their home in Coolfont, with a mid-wife assisting -- and at the age of six weeks attended his first Board meeting! Welcome, Jacob, and congratulations to your parents and big sister.

--Good luck to long-time Coolfont residents Fran and Phil McGunigle who have moved to Catonsville MD (their home and adjoining lot, E-5 and E-6, are for sale)and to another early settler (along with her late husband Art) Dotty Leech, who has moved in to Berkeley Springs.

--Welcome to Daniel and Jeannette Van Belleghem who bought the Leech home (E-7). The Van Belleghems live in Arlington VA and have three children, Dan (17), Margot (15) and Luke(10).

CMA INSURANCE

A letter to the Board from Gerald Sophar regarding our insurance coverage in case of injury to non-members sparked a Board discussion. There was concern that our coverage may indeed be too low for these times. (cont.)

CMA INSURANCE (cont.)

CMA member Robert Harned, who heads his own agency in Gaithersburg, has accepted a Board request to review our current coverage and to discuss the matter with the Board at its next meeting. The Board will also discuss coverage with a representative of The Woods, a vacation community in this area which is similar to ours.

THE COFFER

Treasurer Charles Barrett reports... A new note for $30,000 at 12% simple interest per year was secured Febuary 3. Our old note for $49,378.19 was paid off with $9,378.19 in proceeds from this new note plus $40,000 in CMA cash. The remainder of the new note ($20,621.81) has been deposited, along with $1,146.71 which was on hand, in a growth account at Citizens National Bank of Berkeley Springs and is currently bearing interest in excess of 7.5%. Cash on hand, including the growth account, the maintenance account ($545.63), and recent assessment payments, totals $23,490.87. $6,140 is still owed on assessments. / Ed. Note: These delinquent accounts are being actively pursued by the Treasurer_/ Gross debts, including interest to the end of term on the new note, total $33,000. Current accounts payable: $778.53.

TIME TABLE/COVENANT AMENDMENTS

Note: The Covenant changes reported in the last newsletter (changing the fiscal year, raising the penalty interest on unpaid assessments, and clarifying restraints against business use by homeowners) will not take effect until 1988.

BOARD MEETINGS

The next Board meetings, always open to the membership, will be held April 12 and May 10, 9:30 AM, at the Bannockburn Clubhouse, Bethesda MD. The June meeting will be held at Coolfont.

LETTERS

PLAUDITS

As homeowners in the Coolfont Mountainside Association, my husband and I would like to express appreciation for the beautifully designed first edition of the MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS. It is so nice to get a brief summary of news, and we both want to express our appreciation to you for serving as the editor and for your contribution in getting out an attractive and informational newsletter.

Ed and Mary Kathryn Clark
Winchester, VA

THREE CHEERS

...to the new Board for a great start in seeking the members' participation in CMA's problem solving. The new MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS and opening up the Board's meetings to members are to be applauded. Appointing members to serve on and to chair important committees which are not dominated by Board members is a welcome move. I trust that this will continue throughout the year, including when appointments are made to the Budget and Nominating Committees.

Herb Jasper
Bethesda, MD



What Kind of Community Are We?

There are many items of disagreement between CMA and CDC that can be understood only after extensive historical analyses, but this is not one of these. Are we a "seasonal" community - CDC's view - or are we a "year-round" community?

Let us look at the facts.
1. Of the 56 homes on the mountainside 7 have been occupied in recent months by year-round residents - there have been as many as 10 year-round residents in recent years.

2. Most of the other homes are rented either by their owners to vacationers year-round or through CRI to CRI guests or conferees on a year-round basis.

There are few, if any, homes that are truly seasonal - used only during the summer or the ski (?) season.

Everyone, including CDC and CRI, profits from the year-round nature of our community.

Standards set for our amenities, such as roads, water systems and sewers should reflect this usage.

Morgan County established different standards some years ago for seasonal and for year-round developments, with the full involvement of all developers, including Mr. Ashelman. Why is he so unwilling to apply the appripriate standards to his own development?

Why is the Board even considering - as they have in their last proposal to CDC - "seasonal standards with some exceptions"? Wouldn't "year-round standards with some exceptions" - exceptions where such standards can be shown to be excessive of our present and projected needs - be more realistic?

I believe we should insist on year-round standards for any future development, and that our amenities must be upgraded to year-round standards for the existing community.

Without adequate standards life on the mountainside is hazardous, with roads that are inadequate to accommodate fire-fighting equipment and water outages that verge on creating a public health problem. It is also unnecessarily expensive to CMA members, who must continue to be assessed at high rates for the unceasing need to patch and repair inadequate utilities.

Lets support those whose view reflects the reality that WE ARE A YEAR-ROUND COMMUNITY!

Eva Lehman
Bethesda, MD

/ Ed. Note: The issues raised above are all included in the deliberations of the "bi-partisan" group which has been appointed by the President. See the lead article. /

COOLFONT FOUNDATION SCHEDULE

Saturday, March 22, 8:30 PM, SHENANDOAH TRIO at the Manor House

Saturday, April 5, 8:30 PM, EVELYN SWARTHOUT HAYES, pianist, at the Manor House

Sunday, May 4, 4:00 PM, MARYLAND SYMPHONY SAMPLER, in the Pavilion (behind Treetop House)

Saturday, May 31, 8:30 PM, pianist PETER BASQUIN, at the Manor House

Saturday, May 31, 8:30 PM, pianist BRIAN GANZ and violinist JOSEPH BURSTEIN (performing on a newly-acquired Stradivarius) at the Manor House

"Like an army defeated
The snow hath retreated,
And now doth fare ill
On top the bare hill;
The Ploughboy is whooping--anon
--anon!"

Wordsworth: March